Dr Annika Tjuka

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Academic education

2019–2024 **Doctor philosophiae in Linguistics**, *Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena*.
PhD Thesis: *Language variation in word meanings–Cross-linguistic patterns and causes of colexifications*. DOI: doi.org/10.22032/dbt.71830
Supervisor: Johann-Mattis List
External examiners: Stephen C. Levinson and Asifa Majid
Grade: *summa cum laude* ('with distinction')
DOI: 10.22032/dbt.71830

2016–2019 **Master of Arts in Linguistics,** *Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin*.
Final Grade: 1.2 ('very good')
MA Thesis: *Body-part metaphors as a window to cognition–A cross-linguistic study of object and landscape terms*. DOI: 10.17613/msjz6-wck75
Examiners: Elisabeth Verhoeven and Kilu von Prince
Grade: 1.3 ('very good')

2013–2016 **Bachelor of Arts in German Linguistics and Scandinavian Studies**, *Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin*.
Final Grade: 1.7 ('good')
BA Thesis: *Emotionalisation through texts–A contrastive analysis of donation letters and stock market letters with the help of the Berlin Affective Word List Reloaded.*
Examiners: Katharina Spalek and Manfred Krifka
Grade: 1.5 ('very good')

2012–2013 **Bachelor of Arts in Culture & Technology–Language and Communication**, *Technische Universität Berlin*.

Awards and grants

2026 **Sign up! Career Building Program** for excellent female postdocs to prepare them for management positions in science, Max Planck Society.

2025 **Otto Hahn Medal** for outstanding scientific achievements in connection with doctoral research, Max Planck Society.

2019–2023 **Fellowship**, International Max Planck Research Schools (IMPRS), Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena.

2021 **Farzad Sharifian PhD Student Award** for my presentation *The face of the moon–Body part extensions in Vietnamese* at 3rd Cultural Linguistics International Conference (CLIC-2021), Budapest.

2019 **Humboldt-Price Nomination** for best Master's thesis at Sprach- und literaturwissenschaftliche Fakultät, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin.

2019 **Humboldt-Universität's Equal Opportunities Fund** for participation in a linguistics conference, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin.

Work experience

2023–present	**Postdoctoral Researcher**, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Department of Linguistic and Cultural Evolution, Leipzig, Germany. Project: Exploring diversity in language and cognition
2019–2023	**Doctoral Researcher**, Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena. Project: Cross-linguistic strategies of denotation–Advancing data and methods in lexical typology
2019–2019	**Research Associate**, FAHMRRR project funded by the European Research Council (ERC), Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin. Project: Focus alternatives in the human mind–Retrieval, representation, and recall Principal Investigator: Katharina Spalek
2017–2019	**Student Research Assistant**, MelaTAMP project funded by German Research Foundation (DFG), Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin. Project: Tense, Aspect, Modality, and Polarity in Oceanic Languages of Melanesia Principal Investigators: Kilu von Prince and Manfred Krifka
2016–2019	**Student Research Assistant**, FAHMRRR project funded by the European Research Council (ERC), Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin.
2018–2018	**Internship and Student Research Assistant**, Modulation of Language Networks Group, Max Planck Institute for Human Cognitive and Brain Sciences, Leipzig. Group Leader: Gesa Hartwigsen
2013–2016	**Assistant**, World Wide Fund for Nature, Department of Dialogue Marketing, Berlin.

Publications

Books	**Tjuka, Annika**. 2026. *Variation in word meanings: Cross-linguistic patterns and causes of colexifications*. Berlin: Language Science Press. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.20639911
Journal articles	**Tjuka, Annika** & Johann-Mattis List. 2024. Partial colexifications reveal directional tendencies in object naming. *Yearbook of the German Cognitive Linguistics Association* 12(1). 95–114. DOI: 10.1515/gcla-2024-0005 **Tjuka, Annika**, Robert Forkel & Johann-Mattis List. 2024. Universal and cultural factors shape body part vocabularies. *Scientific Reports* 14(1). 1–12. DOI: 10.1038/s41598-024-61140-0. **Tjuka, Annika**, 2024. Objects as human bodies: Cross-linguistic colexifications between words for body parts and objects. *Linguistic Typology* 28(3). 379-418. DOI: 10.1515/lingty-2023-0032. **Tjuka, Annika**, Huong Thi Thu Nguyen, Ruben van de Vijver, & Katharina Spalek. 2024. Investigating the variation of intonation contours in Northern Vietnamese tones. *Frontiers in Education* 9. 1–9. DOI: 10.3389/feduc.2024.1411660. Kim, Yoolim & **Annika Tjuka** (shared authorship). 2024. Cognitive science from the perspective of linguistic diversity. *Cognitive Science* 48(2). 1–7. DOI: 10.1111/cogs.13418 Nomura, Keiko, Simon Rella, Haily Merritt, Mathieu Baltussen, Darcy Bird, **Annika**

Tjuka & Dan Falk. 2024. Tipping points of space debris in low Earth orbit. *International Journal of the Commons* 18(1). 17–31. DOI: 10.5334/ijc.1275

Tjuka, Annika, Robert Forkel & Johann-Mattis List. 2023. Curating and extending data for language comparison in Concepticon and NoRaRe. *Open Research Europe* 2(141). 1–13. DOI: 10.12688/openreseurope.15380.3.

Tjuka, Annika, Robert Forkel & Johann-Mattis List. 2022. Linking norms, ratings, and relations of words and concepts across multiple language varieties. *Behavior Research Methods* 54. 864–884. DOI: 10.3758/s13428-021-01650-1.

Tjuka, Annika, Huong Thi Thu Nguyen & Katharina Spalek. 2020. *Foxes*, *deer*, and *hedgehogs*: The recall of focus alternatives in Vietnamese. *Laboratory Phonology* 11(1). 1–29. DOI: 10.5334/labphon.253.

Edited volume articles

Bocklage, Katja, Anna Di Natale, **Annika Tjuka** & Johann-Mattis List. forthcoming. Directional tendencies in semantic change. In Johan-Mattis List, Thomas Olander & Florian Wandl (eds.), *Relative chronology in historical linguistics*. Berlin: Language Science Press.

Tjuka, Annika, 2025. The representation of foot/leg polysemy in the mind–Insights from Vietnamese body part extensions with *chân*. In Mateus Cruz Maciei de Carvalho & Iwona Kraska-Szlenk (eds.), *Embodiment in cross-linguistic studies: The 'foot/leg,'* 173–192. Leiden: Brill. DOI: 10.1163/9789004732100_010.

Tjuka, Annika, 2023. Body part extensions with *mắt* 'face' in Vietnamese. In Kelsie E. Pattillo & Małgorzata Waśniewska (eds.), *Embodiment in cross-linguistic studies: The 'face,'* 237–255. Leiden: Brill. DOI: 10.1163/9789004521971_012.

Conference proceedings

Tjuka, Annika, Robert Forkel, Christoph Rzymski & Johann-Mattis List. 2025. Advancing the database of cross-linguistic colexifications with new workflows and data. In Kilian Evang, Laura Kallmeyer & Sylvain Pogodalla (eds.), *Proceedings of the 16th International Conference on Computational Semantics*, 1–15. Düsseldorf: Association for Computational Linguistics.

Tjuka, Annika, 2020. General patterns and language variation: Word frequencies across English, German, and Chinese. In Michael Zock, Emmanuele Chersoni, Alessandro Lenci & Enrico Santus (eds.), *Proceedings of the Workshop on the Cognitive Aspects of the Lexicon*, 23–32. Online and Barcelona: Association for Computational Linguistics.

Tjuka, Annika, Lena Weißmann & Kilu von Prince. 2019. Tagging modality in Oceanic languages of Melanesia. In Annemarie Friedrich, Deniz Zeyrek & Jet Hoek (eds.), *Proceedings of the 13th Linguistic Annotation Workshop*, 65–70. Florence: Association for Computational Linguistics. DOI: 10.18653/v1/W19-4008.

Tjuka, Annika, Lena Weißmann & Kilu von Prince. 2019. Habitual aspect as a property of text spans. In Zygmunt Vetulani & Patrick Paroubek (eds.), Human language technologies as a challenge for computer science and linguistics. *Proceedings of 9th Language & Technology Conference,* 195–199. Poznań: Wydawnictwo Nauka i Innowacje.

Invited talks

2026 **Research Colloquium**, *Studying cross-linguistic polysemy patterns with lexical databases*, Institute of British Studies, Universität Leipzig, Germany.

2025 **Keynote**, *Lexical typology at scale–How databases transform the study of colexifications*, Emerging Topics in Typology (ETT) Conference, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.

2023 **Research Colloquium**, *If a car had feet, where would they be? Using the body as an analogy to name object parts*, Current Topics in General Linguistics, Heinrich Heine University, Düsseldorf, Germany.

Research visits

2026 **University of Oxford**, Department of Experimental Psychology, Oxford, United Kingdom.
A three-month research visit to establish a new collaboration with Asifa Majid, expand my network and familiarise myself with the university's facilities.

Summer school participation

2022 **Complex Systems Summer School**, *A study of complex behavior in systems*, Santa Fe Institute, United States.
An intensive four-week introduction to complex behaviour in mathematical, physical, living, and social systems to transcend disciplinary boundaries, take intellectual risks, and ask big questions. Including lectures, workshops, and a group research project.

2022 **Semantic Shifts Summer School**, *From lexicon to grammar: Diachronic and typological perspectives*, Centre National de la Recherche Scientifique (CNRS), Fréjus, France.
A two-week introduction exploring the crossover between two focal areas of research in semantics–grammaticalization and lexical semantics–from a range of interdisciplinary perspectives, including courses, workshops, and a round table discussion.

2019 **Neurolinguistics Summer School**, *Experimental linguistics in less-studied languages*, Center for Language and Brain at National Research University Higher School of Economics (HSE), Moscow, Russia.
A three-day event of invited talks discussing psycho- and neurolinguistics findings from less-studied languages, including a poster session with contributions from participants.

Teaching (University courses)

Winter term 2026-27 **Seminar** for Master's students, *Language history and semantic change*, Institute of British Studies, Universität Leipzig, Germany.

Summer term 2026 **Seminar** for Bachelor's students, *Word representation in humans and machines*, Institute of British Studies, Universität Leipzig, Germany.

Winter term 2023-24 **Seminar** for Bachelor's students, *Sprachdiversität und Mehrsprachigkeit (Language diversity and multilingualism)*, Chair of Multilingual Computational Linguistics, Universität Passau, Germany.

Winter term 2022-23 **Grundkurs (Undergraduate Course)** for Bachelor's students, *Sprachwissenschaftliche Fragestellungen und Methoden (Questions and methods in linguistics)*, Institut für Deutsche und Niederländische Philologie, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany.

Winter term 2021-22 **Seminar** for Bachelor's students, *Same same but different: Semantic relations in language and thought*, Department of English Studies, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität, Jena, Germany (online).

Summer term 2021	**Seminar** for Bachelor's students, *Words and their meanings across languages*, Department of English Studies, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität, Jena, Germany (online).
Winter term 2020-21	**Seminar** for Bachelor's students, *The mental lexicon from a cross-linguistic perspective*, Department of English Studies, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität, Jena, Germany (online).

Teaching (Lectures)

September 2026	**Lecture** for Master's and PhD students, *Studying meaning with colexification networks*, Summer School–Language Science Meets Linguistic Diversity, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin and Endangered Languages Archive, Berlin, Germany.
September 2025	**Guest lecture** for Master's and PhD students, *Intro to Open Science*, Workshop–Bridging minds: Interdisciplinary approaches in anthropology, evolution and culture, University of Ghana, Accra, Ghana (online).
June 2025	**Teaching material** for High-School students, *The evolution of language*, OpenEvo–Educational innovation research for understanding humans, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.
November 2024	**Guest lecture** for PhD students, *Cognitive science from the perspective of linguistic diversity*, International Max Planck Research School Core Seminar Week, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.
April 2024	**Guest lecture** for Bachelor's students, *Body part vocabularies across languages*, Seminar–Psychology of language taught by Yoolim Kim, Wellesley College. Massachusetts, USA (online).
September 2022	**Lecture** for Master's and PhD students, *Computer-assisted approaches to lexical typology*, co-teacher Johann-Mattis List, Centre national de la recherche scientifique (CNRS), SemanticShifts Summer School, Frejús, France.
August 2021	**Lecture** for Master's and PhD students, *Introduction to linguistic & cultural evolution*, SHH Summer School–A doorway to human history, Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena, Germany (online).
August 2021	**Lecture** for Master's and PhD students, *Bayesian phylogenetic linguistics*, co-teachers Nataliia Hübler and Olena Shcherbakova, SHH Summer School–A doorway to human history, Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena, Germany (online).

Supervision and mentoring

2026	**Supervision of Master's thesis**, Institute of Linguistics, Universität Leipzig. MA student: Mira Ahmedović
2024–present	**Supervisor**, Department of Linguistic and Cultural Evolution, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology. Supervisee: Mira Ahmedovic (Student Research Assistant)
2024–2025	**Mentor**, *Emerging Topics in Typology (ETT) Conference* organised by and for PhD students.
2022–2024	**Supervisor**, Department of Linguistic and Cultural Evolution, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology. Supervisee: Mathilda van Zantwijk (Student Research Assistant)

2022–2023 **Mentor**, African Research Talents Experiencing Mentoring in Science (ARTEMIS) programme, Max Planck Society.
Mentee: Mike Ofori Antwi (Master's student at University of Ghana)

Representative roles

2025–present **Open Science Ambassador**, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.
Achievement: I initiated an institute-wide *Open Science Award* to recognise projects that promote Open Science practices.

2024–2025 **Deputy Open Science Ambassador**, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.

2020–2021 **PhD Representative**, Department of Linguistic and Cultural Evolution, Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena, Germany.

2017–2018 **Women's Representative**, Institute of Romance Studies, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany.

Professional services

2025–present **Guest Editor**, *Topics in Cognitive Science*, Special Issue – Diverse minds: Incorporating diversity into cognitive science research.

2024–present **Exhibition Curator**, Department of Linguistic and Cultural Evolution, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.
Representation of the department in matters relating to the design, curation and communication of the foyer exhibition *What makes us human?*

2023–present **Advisory Committee Member**, *How languages show what speakers know*, Vici Grant.
Principal Investigator: G. Jenneke van der Wal

2021–2024 **Co-Editor** of the blog *Computer-assisted language comparison in practice*. Link: https://calc.hypotheses.org

2020–present **Ad Hoc Reviewer**

- Journals: *Nature Human Behaviour, Scientific Data, Behavior Research Methods, Scientific Reports, Frontiers in Psychology, Cognitive Science, Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology, Cognitive Linguistics, Journal of Language Evolution, Language Dynamics and Change, Review of Cognitive Linguistics, Linguistic Typology at the Crossroads, Journal of Portuguese Linguistics, SKASE Journal of Theoretical Linguistics*
- Conferences: *CogSci Conference, Emerging Topics in Typology (ETT), International Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology*

Event organization

2026 **Workshop**, *Quantitative typology–New directions in assembling and analysing cross-linguistic data*, 16th International Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology, Lyon, France.
A one-day workshop with eight contributions organised together with Christian Bentz and Johann-Mattis List.

Role: Main Organiser

2024 **Workshop**, *Linguistic and cognitive science meet diversity*, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.
A three-day workshop with 18 invited talks and two round table discussions organised together with Yoolim Kim and Yağmur Deniz Kısa.
Role: Main Organiser

2023 **Workshop**, *Cross-linguistic data formats–Graphs and texts*, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.
A two-day workshop with invited talks and two practice sessions organised together with Johann-Mattis List and Robert Forkel.
Role: Co-Organizer

2023 **Theme Session**, *Cross-linguistic colexifications across research fields*, 16th International Cognitive Linguistics Conference, Düsseldorf, Germany.
A one-day theme session with invited talks organised together with Johann-Mattis List.
Role: Co-Organizer

2022 **Group Session**, *Science communication*, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.
A one-day workshop discussing science communication and a poster presentation.
Role: Group leader

2021 **Science of Human History Summer School,** *A doorway to human history*, Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena, online.
A two-week lecture and workshop series introducing the main aspects of archaeology, archaeogenetics, as well as linguistic and cultural evolution.
Role: Organising Committee Member

2020–2021 **Journal Club**, Department of Linguistic and Cultural Evolution, Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena.
Role: Main Coordinator

Outreach activities

2025 **Long Night of Science**, *Der Schatz der Sprachen–Warum wir Wortschätze in Datenbanken sammeln (The treasure of languages–Why we collect vocabularies in databases)*, Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Leipzig, Germany.

2025 **School Event** organised by Soapbox Science and NeuroCure, *Anatomie der Sprache: Eine Reise von Kopf bis Fuß (Anatomy of language: A journey from head to toe)*, Peter-Ustinov-Schule, Berlin, Germany.

2025 **Soapbox Science**, *Anatomie der Sprache: Eine Reise von Kopf bis Fuß (Anatomy of language: A journey from head to toe)*, Holzmarkt, Berlin, Germany.

2024 **Three Minute Thesis competition ('3MT)**, *One body, many words: Linguistic diversity as a window into the mind*, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität, Jena, Germany.

2023 **Quantum Entanglement–Science and Music Festival**, *Was wäre, wenn Du jede Sprache auf der Welt sprechen könntest?*, Heiter bis Wolkig Café Bürgerbahnhof Plagwitz, Leipzig, Germany.

2022 **Tea with Teachers**, *The role of a lifetime–Portrayal of female scientists in today's movies and TV series*, organised together with Olena Tykhostup, Department of English Studies, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität, Jena, online.

2022 **Interview for Stuttgarter Kinderzeitung**, answering a question by 8-year-old Tilda: *How did words actually come into being and from them our language?*

2021 **Tea with Teachers**, *Four ways to a PhD*, organised with Olena Shcherbakova, Olena Tykhostup, and Barthe Bloom, Department of English Studies, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität, Jena, online.

2019 **Long Night of Science,** *Game: Try to get food in the same way as the crows of New Caledonia*, coordinated with Clemens Schmid, Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, Jena.

Languages

German	First language
English	Professional proficiency
Spanish	Intermediate proficiency
Vietnamese	Passive proficiency